STRUCTURES OF TENSE

Tense refers to the grammatical expression of time through verbs. It is basically the concept of time which may be present, past or future.

There are 12 types of tenses in English:

1. **Present Simple:**

Used for actions that are habitual or Universal facts.

Structure - (Subject + V(1) + object+ extension)

(s/es will be added with main verb if the subject is third person singular number.)

Example: "She walks to school every day."

"Ice melts when it is heated"

2. **Present Continuous:**

Describes actions happening at the moment of speaking or ongoing actions.

(Subject + am/is/are+ v(ing)+ object+ extension)

Example: "She is walking to school right now."

3. **Present Perfect:**

Used for actions that happened at an unspecified time before now or actions that started in the past and continue into the present.

(Subject + have/has+ v(3)+ object+ extension)

Example: "She has walked to school many times before."

4. **Present Perfect Continuous:** Describes actions that started in the past, continue into the present, and may continue into the future.

(Subject + have been/has been + v(ing)+ object+ extension)

Example: "She has been walking to school for an hour."

5. **Past Simple:**

Used for actions that happened in the past and are finished.

(Subject + v(2) + object+ extension)

Example: "She walked to school yesterday."

6. **Past Continuous:**

Describes actions that were ongoing in the past.

(Subject + was/were + v(ing)+ object+ extension)

Example: "She was walking to school when it started to rain."

7. **Past Perfect:**

Used for actions completed before another action in the past.

(Subject + had + v(3)+ object+ extension)

Example: "She had walked to school before it started raining."

8. **Past Perfect Continuous:** Describes actions that were ongoing in the past up to a certain point.

(Subject + had been + v(ing)+ object+ extension)

Example: "She had been walking to school for an hour when it started raining."

9. **Future Simple:**

Used for actions that will happen in the future.

(Subject + shall/will + v(1)+ object+ extension)

Example: "She will walk to school tomorrow."

10. **Future Continuous:**

Describes ongoing actions that will happen in the future.

(Subject + shall be/ will be + v(ing)+ object+ extension)

Example: "She will be walking to school at this time tomorrow."

11. **Future Perfect:**

Used for actions that will be completed before a certain point in the future.

(Subject + shall have/will have + v(3)+ object+ extension)

Example: "She will have walked to school by the time it starts raining."

12. **Future Perfect Continuous:**

Describes actions that will continue up to a certain point in the future.

(Subject + shall have been/ will have been + v(ing)+ object+ extension)

Example: "She will have been walking to school for an hour by the time it starts raining."